

# Mahatma Gandhi

The man who **DEFIED** an empire

Gandhi, an icon of peaceful resistance, pioneered nonviolent methods of protest against the British government in India. He is known as the “Father of India.”

## Early struggles

Mohandas Gandhi (known as **Mahatma** or “great soul”) was born on October 2, 1869 in Porbandar, India. He studied law in London, England, and then spent 20 years in South Africa, joining the struggle for **BASIC RIGHTS** for Indian immigrants. He was **arrested many times**, before the government gave in to his demands. When Gandhi returned to India, he found that the British, who had ruled India as a colony since 1858, had passed strict laws to control the Indian population.

### By the way...

I believe that reacting to violence with more violence is foolish. In a speech, I once said “an eye for an eye makes the whole world blind.”

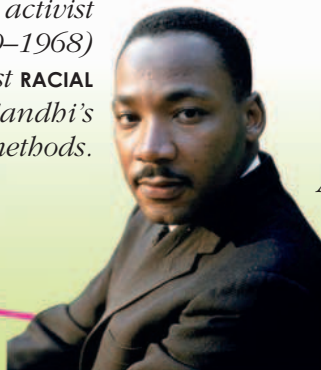
### Did you know?

When Gandhi died, he owned only 10 possessions including a watch, sandals, eyeglasses, and an eating bowl.



He paved the way for...

American civil rights activist **MARTIN LUTHER KING** (1929–1968) campaigned against **RACIAL INEQUALITIES** using Gandhi's nonviolent methods.



**NELSON MANDELA** (1918–) led the struggle in South Africa to end **APARTHEID**, laws that kept people separate based on race. He became South Africa's first black president.

